Megadiverse Australia

Biodiversity is a term used to describe the range of living things in an area. The word comes from the term 'biological **diversity**' and includes plants, animals and microorganisms.

☞ **1** Put the following organisms in the right category.

marsupials	parrots	eucalypts	protozoa
monotremes	fish	acacias	coral

Plants	Animals	Microorganisms

Some countries, especially those with **tropical** forests, such as Australia, have huge numbers of **unique** plants and animals. These countries are called **megadiverse**. Even though they cover a small amount of the Earth's surface, they support a large amount of its biodiversity. Australia also provides many different **climatic** conditions and **habitats**. This means that Australia is home to many different **ecosystems**, each with a diverse range of species.

☞ **2** Unique means **a)** native **b)** one of a kind **c)** special **d)** different.

3 Why are Brazil, the Congo and India megadiverse countries? _____

_____

4 The table below lists some habitats found in Australia. List as many Australian animals as you can for each habitat.

Coral reef	Desert	Tropical rainforest	Wooded grassland	Temperate rainforest
• shark • crab	• bilby • snake	• tree frog	• emu • echidna	• leech • lyrebird

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